Historical source

Encyclopaedia Britannica scan, source row 2155. Parse 3.5 extracted the text. Super 3.5 VL corrected it from an enlarged crop of each block. It can still contain recognition errors. Page headers, footers, and page numbers are removed.

Untitled continuation (E0183)

Continues an entry from an earlier page.

Blind. that fee them, until they are taught by a master or tutor; I have (for the good-will I bear to such unfortunate persons) contrived the following table;

that, by feeling, they may understand notes, and learn any tune that shall be set them, in their master's absence.

A New Music-Table for such as are Blind.

EXPLANATION (E0184)

EXPLANATION.

Let AB be a Smooth board, 3 or 4 feet long, 1 inch thick, and 9 inches wide, with 5 square ledges glued thereon, each being half an inch asunder, half an inch wide, and half an inch high; which rifling ledges represent our 5 lines of music, and their spaces: and the two outward lines, being made a little lower, may serve as leger lines, on occasion. The cyphers represent so many holes bored into every line and space, half an inch asunder; wherein pegs of different shapes are to be set, to represent the several sorts of notes and characters of the tune: which pegs the blind person may know by feeling, as well as he does his keys of the organ or harpsichord: so that, by keeping his fingers on the 5 lines, he feels the several pegs as they come on, and are set to represent the several sorts of notes, on both line and space; whilst his right hand strikes the respective key, &c. he first knowing the names of all his keys, his lines, spaces, and the mark of every peg. Let each peg be about half an inch high, when set in very fast. [N. B. The blind person must first be taught the names of the above lines and spaces in both the treble and bass cliffs; and that he must feel his treble with his right hand, and his bass with the left hand; each being contrary, as you may see by the letters of the above table, A and B; and must learn each part separate.]

and must learn each part separate.] " Of pegs, he must have a great number of every fold, to set his tune with, which he may mark as sol- lows :

For a Semibreve, 4 top-notches.

Minim, 2 top-notches.

Mann, 2 top-notches. Crochet, 1 top-notch.

Crotchet, 1 top-notch. Quaver, one corner cut off.

Quadrant, one corner cut off. Semiquadrant, 2 corners cut off.

Semiquaver, 2 corners cut off. Demisemiquaver, all 4 corners cut off.

Replo, a notch in the course.

A Flat, a notch on the side.

A Flat, 1 notch on the side. Sharp, 2 notches on the side. Point, 3 notches on the side.

Bas, a first thin top.

Bar, a flat thin top. Repeat, a sharp-pointed top, &c. &c. &c.

But it is best for every performer to make and mark his own pegs; and deliver them one

by one as they are called for by the person that sets his tone.

Thus far our authors. We have already complained, that Tanfure's Musical Notation is imperfect; and perhaps every table or instrument of the same kind may be liable to the same censure, as not being comprehensive of all the characters in the written language of music, so that the blind reader may find no deficiency in acquiring any lesson; yet as the cushion of Mr Cheese appears to have more powers than any other instrument for the same purpose that has hitherto occurred to our observation, though attended with many formidable objections, we here insert it. It may possibly, however, be felt for every blind adept in the musical art, after being sufficiently instructed in its theoretical and practical principles, to invent for himself a table, by which may be expressed all the various phenomena of music, in which, by varying the forms and positions of his pegs, he may habitually accustom them with sounds, durations, rels, intervals, chords, cadences, da capos, repeats, and all the various graces which give animation and expression to musical sounds: for thus, being the immediate creatures of his own imagination, they will more easily become familiar to his memory, and be more strongly and readily associated with the phenomena which they are intended to signify, than if he had availed the inventions of any other.

Mr Chee's description of his machine for teaching music to people deprived of sight, and to enable them to preserve their compositions, in the art of composing, without the assistance of a copyist."That part of the machine which represents the book, or paper, is a small cushion stuffed, on a little frame; along which, is fixed a number of pack-thread fringes at equal distances from each other; these represent the lines in a music book: the five which compose the stave, are made of large twine; and those which represent the leger or occasional lines, drawn through the heads of the notes, where the music exceeds the compass of the established stave, are made of small twine, and are on this machine of the same length as the others.

this machine of the fame length as the others. "If the practitioner only wishes to write harpsichord music, the cushion may be what length he pleases, and about five or fix inches wide : the fringes must be sewed in the following order ; beginning with the first

Source record

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